



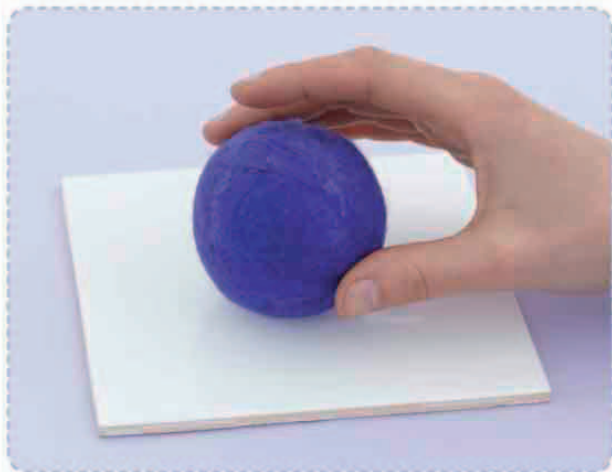
3 Place a small drop of washing-up liquid in your left hand. Using your right hand, dip the ball into the bowl of hot, soapy water. Soak the wool completely but do not let the tufts come apart.



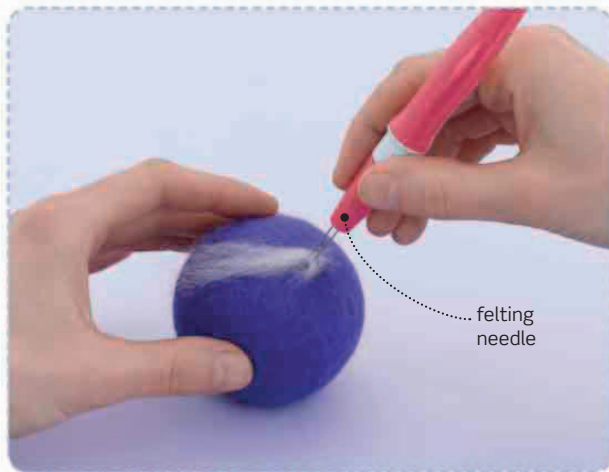
4 Roll the ball lightly between your hands. Continue to roll in a circular motion for a few minutes until the ball is firm, indicating that the wool fibres of the tufts have bonded together.



5 Wrap the ball in another tuft and repeat steps 3 and 4. Continue to build up the layers, alternating the direction of the fibres as in step 2. Dip the ball in hot water and use more washing-up liquid, as necessary. The larger your ball gets, the longer the tufts of roving must be to wrap around.



6 Once your ball has reached a suitable size, approximately 7–8cm (2¾–3in), rinse it under warm water to remove the washing-up liquid. Make sure the finished ball is large enough that it is not a choking hazard for baby. Leave the ball to dry on a surface you are not concerned about becoming stained, as some dye may leach out of the wool.



7 Once the ball is dry, you can add intricate designs using scraps of differently coloured wool roving. Lay the roving on the ball roughly in its final position, then work it into the ball by stabbing straight up and down with a felting needle. This bonds the fibres together. Add more wool as needed to achieve the precise design you want.